

MARCUS VAN DER MEER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 8 years building distributed systems and leading technical direction at scale. I started my career debugging legacy monoliths and have spent the last four years architecting microservices that handle millions of daily transactions. I'm most energized when solving infrastructure bottlenecks and mentoring engineers through complex design problems. Based in Amsterdam, I'm looking for roles where I can shape platform strategy and work with teams tackling real performance challenges.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Horizon Systems

<https://www.horizon-systems.io>

Amsterdam, Netherlands

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented event-driven architecture processing 50 million events daily, reducing data pipeline latency by 65% through strategic use of Kafka and stream processing.

Led migration of monolithic payment system to microservices, mentoring five engineers through implementation and establishing standards that reduced deployment time from 4 hours to 12 minutes.

Established observability framework using Prometheus and Grafana across 40+ services, enabling the team to identify production issues 10 times faster and reduce MTTR from 2 hours to 8 minutes.

Conducted architectural reviews for eight cross-functional teams, identifying critical bottlenecks in database queries and caching strategies that improved system throughput by 40%.

Senior Software Engineer

DataFlow Technologies

<https://dataflow-tech.co>

Amsterdam, Netherlands

June 2019 - February 2022

Built real-time analytics engine in Go handling 100k requests per second, optimizing query performance through aggressive indexing and algorithmic improvements that reduced p99 latency from 800ms to 120ms.

Owned backend infrastructure for customer-facing APIs serving 15 enterprise clients, maintaining 99.95% uptime while scaling from 2 to 12 server instances through load testing and capacity planning.

Introduced contract testing and improved test coverage from 42% to 78%, preventing 23 production incidents over two years and building team confidence in deployment processes.

Mentored four junior engineers in system design and code quality practices, with three promoted to mid-level roles within 18 months.

Software Engineer

TechCore Solutions BV

<https://www.techcore.nl>

Amsterdam, Netherlands

August 2016 - May 2019

Developed backend services for logistics platform using Java Spring Boot, serving 500+ daily active users with features for shipment tracking and invoice generation.

Optimized PostgreSQL queries and added strategic caching with Redis, improving average response times from 1.2 seconds to 240 milliseconds.

Collaborated with DevOps team to containerize legacy applications using Docker and deploy to Kubernetes, reducing deployment failures by 85%.

Built internal monitoring dashboards and alerting system that caught database connection leaks before they caused production outages.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

University of Amsterdam

Amsterdam, Netherlands

2014 - 2016

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

Hogeschool van Amsterdam

Amsterdam, Netherlands

2010 - 2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Java, Python, SQL, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, Elasticsearch

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Jenkins

Data and Messaging: Kafka, Apache Spark, RabbitMQ, Protocol Buffers

Tools and Platforms: Git, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, DataDog

Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven Systems, Domain-Driven Design, CQRS

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/mvandermeer/stream-processor - Kafka consumer library in Go with exactly-once semantics and dead letter queue handling

github.com/mvandermeer/cache-layer - Distributed caching abstraction supporting Redis and Memcached with automatic invalidation

github.com/mvandermeer/load-balancer - Custom TCP load balancer written in Go demonstrating consistent hashing and health check algorithms

github.com/mvandermeer/schema-validator - JSON schema validation tool with performance benchmarks and CLI interface